on the recommendation of Ed Hinckley, a fellow Professor of Industrial Arts. For this publication, Dale visited my workshop and photographed me at work in my own surroundings.

After the seminar Richard, Bruce Mitchell and I stayed with David Ellsworth, for playtime in the workshop and to share our party tricks. Giles Gilson and Del Stubbs joined us; both had skills to die for. Del made the first commercial woodturning video for Taunton in around 1983/4 and his boyish enthusiasm is a joy. Giles could work any material, but his radical paint treatments are what he is best known for; he was a unique individual, a maverick touched with genius. He endeared himself instantly to me at the seminar. Albert LeCoff had sent two pieces of wood to each presenter, asking us to make something to present: Giles's response was two plastic containers full of wood ash.

US TURNING MASTERS

Although it wasn't the case that all the creative forces were only in North America in the early 1980s, there were some pretty powerful pioneers who were better exposed through the US media. Here are a few of the innovators and acknowledged masters:

- Bob Stocksdale made delicate bowls from extraordinary woods. Some compared his work with Chinese porcelain; his reply was usually, "yes they have been copying me for 2000 years."
- Ed Moulthrop pioneered the use of PEG, which allowed him to turn complete log diameters without disintegration
  This material filled the vessels and stopped shrinkage and cell collapse; once stabilized it was more like turning plastic than wood with only certain finishes being compatible. His son Philip and grandson Matt continue Ed's tradition (see Community News)
- Rude Osolnik turned anything found or distressed; old fence posts were a favourite, though to large laminated blocks of Baltic birch plywood. His signature pieces included natural edged bowls. Proceeds from his elegant candlesticks, of which he made 150,000, put his four kids through college
- Mel Lindquist turned his hollow vessels through a largish base hole which he then plugged, or he made them in two parts with a disguised joint
- Mark Lindquist, Mel's son, used decaying spalted woods; he distressed surfaces by chain saw or gouge for decorative effect
- David Ellsworth truly pioneered thin walled enclosed vessels, through extremely small openings. No jigs for him: just touch, feel and sound; a true master. David can enunciate all the art speak in the world and communicate with someone just starting out with equal success. We have known one another 35 years now and I think of him as a true and generous friend who is always willing to gift items for a turning cause
- Dale Nish was not such a pioneering turner as some of those above, but his contribution looms large. He was best known as an educator, a facilitator, an opportunity-provider and writer. He started the long-running Utah Woodturning Symposium in 1979. His most unique pieces were his wormy ash (*Fraxinus excelsior*) vessels
- James Prestini's work is in countless museum collections. He was turning wood in the 1930s, producing refined pure forms which was not the norm at the time, before moving on to other materials. In a way, Prestini predated the modern movement of today but had been ground breaker in his time

Ed Moulthrop – Osage Orange Ellipsoid Vessel

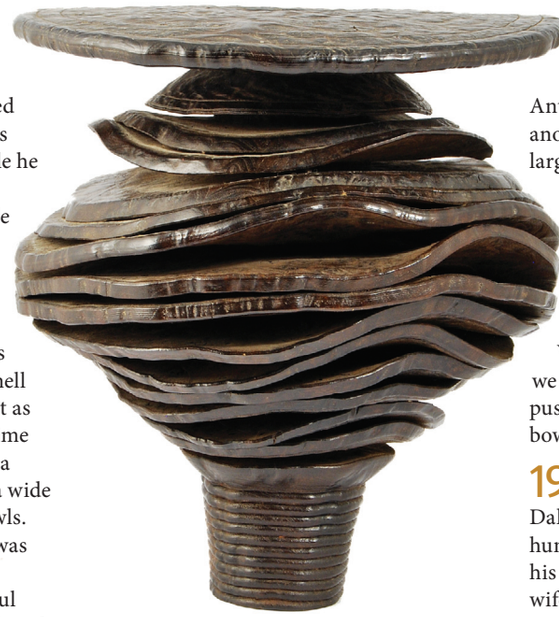
Dale Nish – Nagare Vessell, in sandblasted wormy ash

UK turners

Here in the UK, David Pye developed his fluting engine to add decoration to boxes and bowls. Jim Partridge pioneered ultra thin, wet-turned bowls and bangles from mostly holly (*Ilex aquifolium*) while he was a student at Parnham House.
It wasn't long before he rejected this style of turning and turned to chunky burr pieces: scorched and black, they looked like relics from another age.

Richard Raffan popularised the new wet wood movement. On one of his trips to Scotland he introduced Mick O'Donnell to this technique. Mick was ready to quit as the African woods he was using at the time were affecting his health; wet wood was a revelation and enabled him to produce a wide range of eye-catching, bird-inspired bowls.

The wet wood genre of woodturning was developed further by Melvyn Firmager, producing shadow image vessels and Paul Clare, with his burr elm (*Ulmus procera*) and oak (*Quercus robur*) wood slit pots. Paul was the UK's most creative maker for about ten years; our conservative UK tastes were not ready for much of his creativity. Anthony Bryant took wet tuned wood to another level in time with his extraordinary large oak thin walled vessels.



Paul Clare – Burr Elm Slip Pot

Nick Davidson of Craft Supplies UK started mini seminar weekends in 1981. Nick had been one of the trade sponsors of the Parnham House seminar in 1980.

All around the world at this time, there were other makers being creative. We just were not as aware of them as we are today. In Australia, Vic Wood was pushing boundaries with his big square edge bowls and sculptural boxes.

1982

Dale Nish spent a week with me, taking hundreds of photos over my shoulder for his *Master Woodturners* publication. My wife Liz had convinced me I should have an exhibition of my work; I was reluctant as it was almost a last throw of the dice. Dale

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